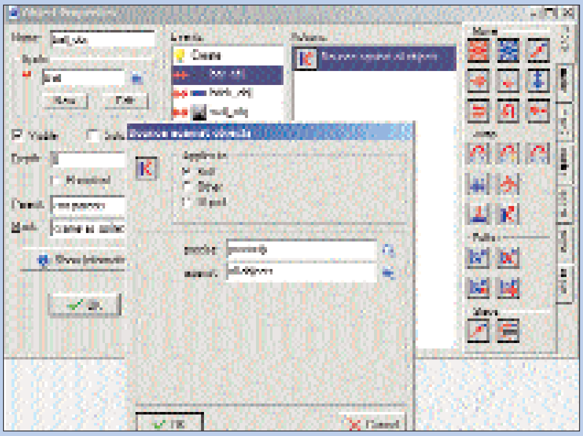


Setting up collisions for the Ball

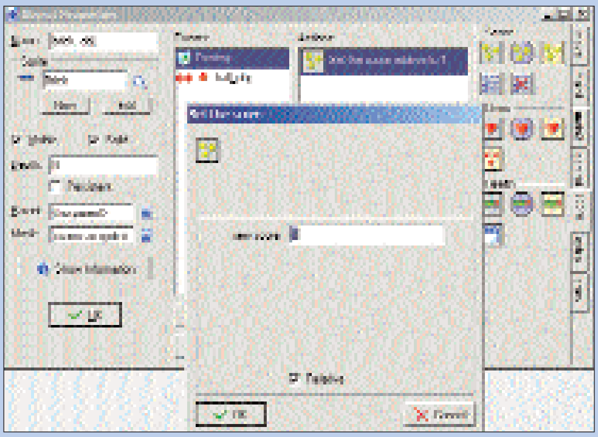
direction when the game starts. To do this, add a Create event and drag the Start Moving in a Direction icon into the Actions region. Depress all three arrows at the top to make it choose a random upward direction. Set the speed to "8".

The next thing we need to do is create a collision even for the bat. The ball is supposed to bounce off it, so drag the "Bounce Against Objects" button from the Jump panel on the right. In the dialog that comes up, select "Precisely" and "Against All Objects". Do the same for the brick and the wall, but choose "Against Solid Objects" this time.

You're supposed to lose the ball if you miss it, so we'll delete it if it leaves the room. From the Event Selector, choose Other, and select Outside Room. Select the "main1" tab from the right and from under the Objects panel, drag the Destroy the Instance icon (the one that looks like the Windows Recycle Bin) into the Actions region.

STEP 5 Back To The Bricks

Edit the Brick object again and add a collision event with the Ball object. Just like you did for the ball, create a "Destroy the Instance" Action for the brick. Finally, we'll add a score point every time a brick is destroyed. To do this, add a Destroy event, and from the Score tab on the right, drag the Set the Score icon (the first one) to the Actions region. In the dialog, enter the points you want to add after each brick is destroyed and make sure you choose Relative so that scores are *added* and not just assigned.

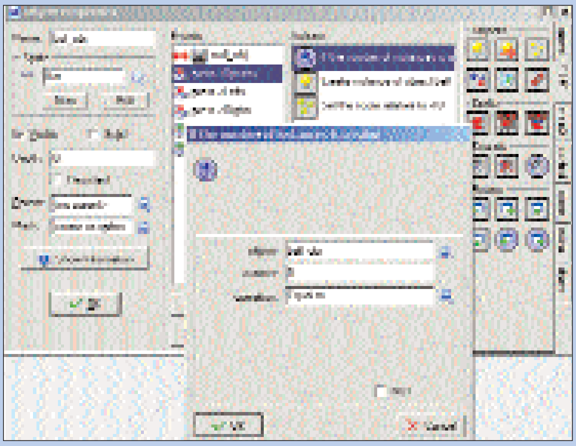


Adding points to Bricks

STEP 6 More Balls!

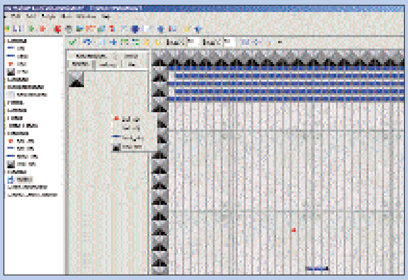
We've created an event where the ball will be destroyed if missed, but we also need to create a new ball each time. You *could* create the ball automatically, or wait for the player to hit a key. We'll do the latter here, but the procedure remains the same—you just need to know which event to assign the action to.

Edit the bat object—add another Key Press event for the space bar. We're first going to see if the previous ball has indeed been destroyed—there should be 0 balls in the room. Select the Control tab on the right and choose the "If the number of instances is a value" icon from the Questions panel. In the dialog, choose the ball object as the object you want to check, the number is 0, and the operation is Equal to.



Checking the number of Balls in the Room

If there aren't any balls in the room, we'll create a new one, and also pile on a score penalty of 10 points for needing to create one. To create a new ball, select the Create Instance of Object icon from the "main1" tab and choose the ball object in the dialog. Finally, add a Set the Score action to this, set the score to "-10" and choose Relative.



Placing objects in the Room

STEP 7 The Room

Now that we've set up the game's rules and the objects' behaviours, we need to create a room for all this to happen.

Go to **Add** > **Add Room** to add one. In the Room Properties dialog, you can place all the sprites where you want them. Click inside the Objects panel to select the object you are going to place in the room. Click in the room layout to place the object. Start with the wall object and place them along all but the bottom edge of the room. To remove an object from the room, right-click on it. Do the same for the bricks, the ball and the bat.

You're done! Run the game by clicking on the Play icon on the toolbar.

This is, of course, nowhere near as complex as the original Arkanoid—you can add a lot more: special bricks, power-ups, monsters... anything you like. You can also create new levels (rooms) and rules for the game. Go wild! ■

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